UNMASKED

The Hollow Creek Board Game · print-and-play

Solve the haunting. Unmask the person. 1 to 5 players · ages 10+ · about 45 minutes.

What you need

- This printout: a 4-sheet board, 85 cards, card backs and a token sheet.
- 4 pawns for the Solvers and 1 for the Haunter (or use the Solver cards' corners), a six-sided die, about 20 small cubes or coins for Fear.
- Optional: the Unmasked video game as a companion app. It hides the culprit and plays the Haunter, so nobody has to.

The goal

A Hollow Creek resident is wearing a folklore mask to cover up something ordinary. Find two true clues, build a trap at the case house, catch the Haunter and name who is under the mask before the clock strikes midnight (round 12).

Setup

1. Pick a case: Pemberton Cottage, the Farm, the Willow Lane Victorian or Blackwood Manor (the Historical Society is the finale, after the other four). Take its case card, 4 suspect cards and its 8 clue tokens.
2. Pick a Folklore Mask card for the Haunter and shuffle the 6 Haunt cards (reshuffle when they run out).
3. **Hide the culprit.** App: it picks. Without the app: one player who will not be a Solver (or a friend) shuffles the 4 suspects and secretly takes one. Its 3 trait icons are the true clues.
4. Take the 3 true clue tokens, plus 2 other clue tokens from the same house as decoys with a decoy marker hidden under each, plus 3 "nothing here" blanks. Shuffle all 8 face down and lay them on the case house space and the nearest lantern spaces.
5. Solvers start at Club HQ. The Haunter starts on the case house. Midnight marker on 1.

A round

1. **Solvers** each take 2 actions: **Move** up to 3 spaces · **Search** (flip a clue token where you stand) · **Interview** (read a suspect's alibi) · **Light** a lantern on a lantern space and hang it on the Hook Board · **Fetch/Build** a trap piece (pieces wait at HQ) · use your **ability**.
2. **Haunter:** flip the top Haunt card and do it, then move 2 spaces toward the nearest Solver. A human Haunter instead spends 3 Ectoplasm on the same powers or on moves.
3. **Clock:** move the midnight marker one hour.

Fear

Hauntings add Fear to your Solver card. At 5 you run back to HQ and skip a turn, then drop to 2. Nobody is ever out. Each time someone runs, the board's Fear track rises one; when it reaches the ghost, the Haunter gets away.

Clues and decoys

Every suspect has one unique trait (circled red on their card) and two shared ones, so **any two true clues name exactly one suspect**. Decoys point the wrong way but can always be disproved: on a lit lantern space, spend an action to lift one found clue. A ghost marker underneath means it was a decoy. You can also check an alibi at the place a suspect names (2 checks a game).

Lanterns

Every 4 lanterns on the Hook Board, all Solvers drop 1 Fear. Light all 12 for a bonus sticker in the campaign.

Catching the Haunter and unmasking

1. With two true clues found, build the 3 trap pieces on the case house space.
2. When the Haunter is on or next to the trap, any Solver there may spring it: roll the die. 1 to 4 catches the Haunter (with the Spook die, a lantern or ghost face).
3. Accuse. Right: read the culprit's motive aloud and win. Wrong: lose an hour and try again. Pemberton allows 3 accusations, the other houses 2.

The Haunter wins at the end of round 12 or when the Fear track fills.

Haunted places

Six haunted places sit around the town: Ravencrag Castle, Cackling Circus, Crowley Tower, Saltmarsh Harbor, Smugglers' Cave and Witchwood Swamp. Each has a card with a small haunting to bust. Busting one earns a Curio token: discard it any time for an extra move, a free lift-check or 1 less Fear.

Modes

- **Solo:** play two Solvers against the Haunt deck.
- **Co-op:** 2 to 4 Solvers against the Haunt deck or the app.
- **Versus:** one player is the Haunter and secretly one of the suspects. They seed the clues, plant up to 2 decoys and spend Ectoplasm. Solvers win by unmasking them.
- **Family:** no decoys, 8 rounds.
- **Campaign:** play houses 1 to 4, then the Historical Society finale, "The Mask Keeper".

Playing with the video game

Each case card has a code (Pemberton is HC-01-LANTERN). The video game's Board Game Companion screen can run the case for you: it picks the culprit, tells you where clues go, plays the Haunter with sounds and keeps the clock. Codes only add album stickers and fresh setups. Nothing is ever sold.

Printing

Print at 100% on letter paper, card stock if you can. Trim the 4 board sheets on the image edge and tape them in a square (A top-left, B top-right, C bottom-left, D bottom-right). Cards are poker size (2.5 x 3.5 in) and fit standard sleeves; print the backs page if you want matching backs, or sleeve over a playing card.

Board sheet A of 4



Trim on the image edge. A top-left · B top-right · C bottom-left · D bottom-right. Assembled board: 15 x 15 in.

Board sheet B of 4



Trim on the image edge. A top-left · B top-right · C bottom-left · D bottom-right. Assembled board: 15 x 15 in.

Board sheet C of 4



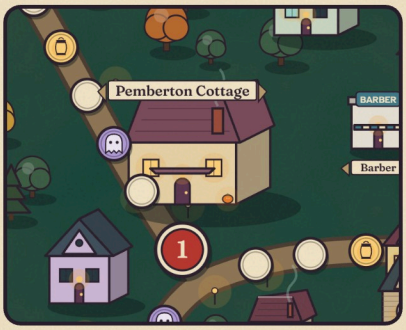
Trim on the image edge. A top-left · B top-right · C bottom-left · D bottom-right. Assembled board: 15 x 15 in.

Board sheet D of 4



Trim on the image edge. A top-left · B top-right · C bottom-left · D bottom-right. Assembled board: 15 x 15 in.

CASE 1 · PEMBERTON



The
Missing Harvest Lantern

The Harvest Lantern that leads the festival's lantern walk has vanished from Mrs. Pemberton's mantel, and her teapot hasn't stopped rattling since.

Case code HC-01-LANTERN

SUSPECT · 1 Pemberton



Hank Moody

Handyman

Sawdust · Spare key · Potting soil

Alibi: Garden Shed

SUSPECT · 1 Pemberton



Daisy Pemberton

Granddaughter

Glitter · Spare key · Gold locket

Alibi: Diner

SUSPECT · 1 Pemberton



Leonard Crisp

Estate agent

Hair pomade · Gold locket · Chamomile tea

Alibi: Elm Street

SUSPECT · 1 Pemberton



Beatrice Hollis

Next-door neighbour

Icing sugar · Chamomile tea · Potting soil

Alibi: Kitchen

CLUE · 1 Pemberton



Pile of sawdust

Points to: Sawdust

Fresh sawdust, the kind you get from sawing a shed door.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE · 1 Pemberton



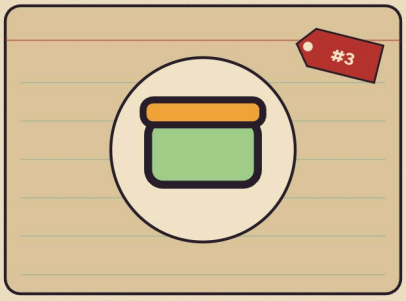
Pink glitter

Points to: Glitter

Party glitter, still sparkling on the windowsill.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE · 1 Pemberton



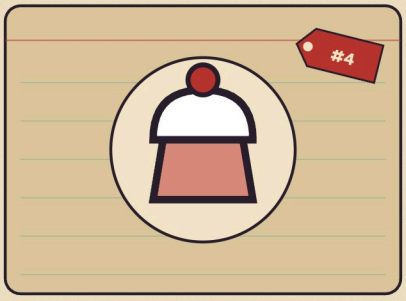
Greasy smudge

Points to: Hair pomade

A hair-pomade smudge on the hall mirror. Smells of limes.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE · 1 Pemberton



Icing sugar

Points to: Icing sugar

A dusting of icing sugar on the doorknob.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE · 1 Pemberton



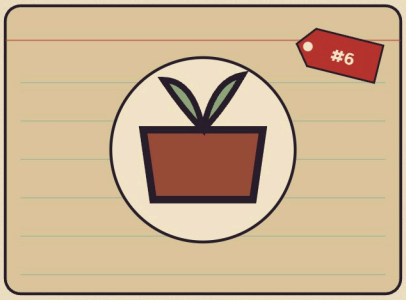
Spare key

Points to: Spare key

The spare key from under the flowerpot, left on the rug.

Two suspects share this

CLUE · 1 Pemberton



Potting soil

Points to: Potting soil

Rich potting soil from the vegetable patch, trodden indoors.

Two suspects share this

CLUE · 1 Pemberton



Gold locket

Points to: Gold locket

A gold locket with a tiny photo of the cottage inside.

Two suspects share this

CLUE · 1 Pemberton



Spilled tea leaves

Points to: Chamomile tea

Chamomile tea leaves, scattered as if the pot leapt by itself.

Two suspects share this

CASE 2 · FARM



The
Sabotaged Prize Display

Someone wrecked the farm's prize pumpkin display the night before judging, and the scarecrow keeps moving.

Case code HC-02-PUMPKIN

SUSPECT · 2 Farm



Abel Hatcher

Farmer

Hay seeds · Barn key · Corn husks

Alibi: Windmill

SUSPECT · 2 Farm



Clementine Hatcher

Harvest Queen

Pageant glitter · Barn key · Rodeo buckle

Alibi: Parlor

SUSPECT · 2 Farm



Silas Crane

Land developer

Surveyor's chalk · Rodeo buckle · Tractor grease

Alibi: Post Office

SUSPECT · 2 Farm



Ma Jessup

Runs the pie stand

Apple peel · Tractor grease · Corn husks

Alibi: Farm Kitchen

CLUE · Farm



Hay seeds

Points to: Hay seeds

Seeds from the very top of the hayloft, stuck in a boot tread.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE · Farm



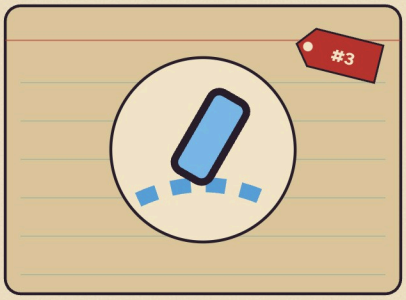
Gold glitter

Points to: Pageant glitter

Gold pageant glitter on the ladder rungs.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE · Farm



Surveyor's chalk

Points to: Surveyor's chalk

Bright blue chalk, the kind used to mark out building plots.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE · Farm



Apple peel

Points to: Apple peel

A long curl of apple peel, still fresh.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE · Farm



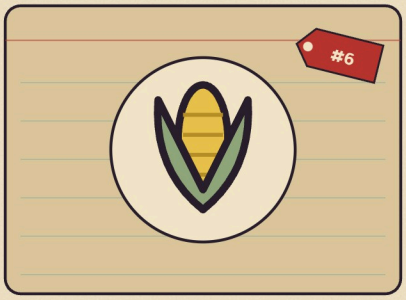
Barn key

Points to: Barn key

The big iron key to the barn, dropped in the straw.

Two suspects share this

CLUE · Farm



Corn husks

Points to: Corn husks

Husks from the maze, tucked into a pocket and dropped.

Two suspects share this

CLUE · Farm



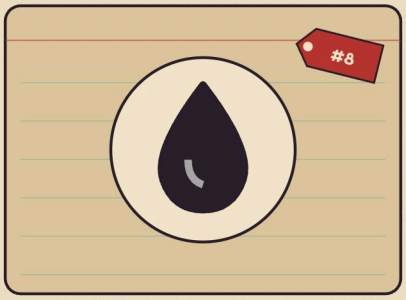
Rodeo belt buckle

Points to: Rodeo buckle

A shiny silver buckle shaped like a horseshoe.

Two suspects share this

CLUE · Farm



Tractor grease

Points to: Tractor grease

Black grease on the hayloft hatch. Someone's been near an engine.

Two suspects share this

CASE 3 · VICTORIAN



The Interrupted Recital

The nursery music box keeps cutting off Lavinia's charity recital, and the donation tin went missing in the fuss.

Case code HC-03-RECITAL

SUSPECT · Victorian



Ezra Cole

Caretaker

Hedge clippings · Skeleton key · Graveyard dirt

Alibi: Family Plot

SUSPECT · Victorian



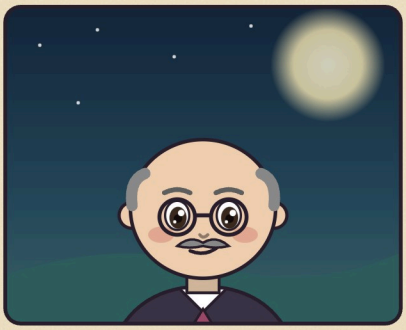
Lavinia Ashcombe

The last Ashcombe

Violet perfume · Skeleton key · Velvet thread

Alibi: Master Bedroom

SUSPECT · Victorian



Dr. Felix Marlowe

Music-box collector

Pipe tobacco · Velvet thread · Candle wax

Alibi: Bookshop

SUSPECT · Victorian



Agnes Pratt

Housekeeper

Silver polish · Candle wax · Graveyard dirt

Alibi: Dining Room

CLUE · Victorian



Hedge clippings

Points to: Hedge clippings

Fresh clippings from the front hedge, tracked up the stairs.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE · Victorian



Scent of violets

Points to: Violet perfume

Violet perfume, faint but unmistakable, in the nursery.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE · Victorian



Pipe tobacco

Points to: Pipe tobacco

A pinch of cherry pipe tobacco on the windowsill.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE · Victorian



Silver polish

Points to: Silver polish

A smear of silver polish on the music box's key.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE · Victorian



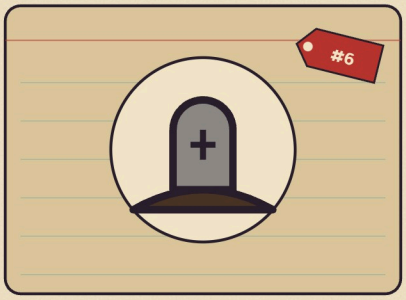
Skeleton key

Points to: Skeleton key

An old skeleton key that opens the nursery door.

Two suspects share this

CLUE ③ Victorian



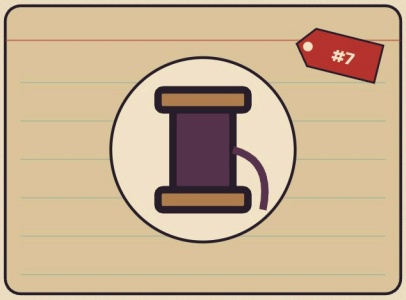
Graveyard dirt

Points to: Graveyard dirt

Dark soil from the family plot, still damp.

Two suspects share this

CLUE ③ Victorian



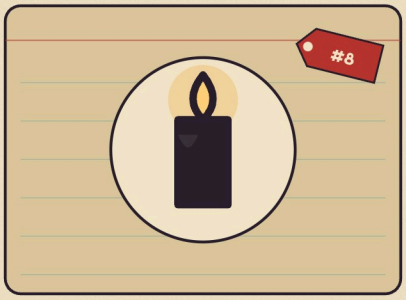
Velvet thread

Points to: Velvet thread

A thread of plum velvet caught on the trapdoor.

Two suspects share this

CLUE ③ Victorian



Candle wax

Points to: Candle wax

Drips of black candle wax leading to the tower stairs.

Two suspects share this

CASE 4 · BLACKWOOD



The
Missing Blackwood Ledger

The 1823 town ledger, which says who really owns half of Hollow Creek, has vanished from the Library.

Case code HC-04-LEDGER

SUSPECT ④ Blackwood



Gus Thornbury

Groundskeeper

Muddy boots · Master keys · Gardening

Alibi: Greenhouse

SUSPECT ④ Blackwood



Vivian Blackwood

Heiress

Perfume · Master keys · Jewelry

Alibi: Library

SUSPECT ④ Blackwood



Reginald Pike

Rival antiques dealer

Cigar ash · Jewelry · Leather gloves

Alibi: Diner

SUSPECT ④ Blackwood



Martha Bunce

Cook

Flour · Leather gloves · Gardening

Alibi: Kitchen

CLUE ④ Blackwood



Muddy boot print

Points to: Muddy boots

Fresh garden mud, heavy work boots.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE ④ Blackwood



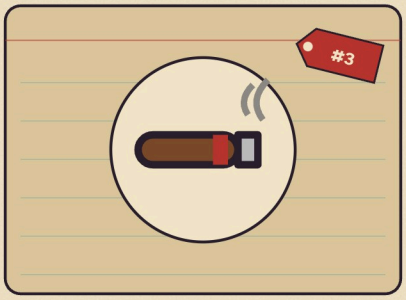
Whiff of lavender

Points to: Perfume

Expensive lavender perfume lingers on the curtain.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE ④ Blackwood



Cigar ash

Points to: Cigar ash

Still-warm ash from an imported cigar.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE ④ Blackwood



Floury handprint

Points to: Flour

A perfect handprint in baking flour.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE ④ Blackwood



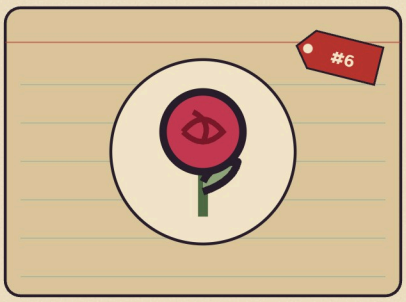
Dropped key ring

Points to: Master keys

A ring of old master keys to the manor.

Two suspects share this

CLUE ④ Blackwood



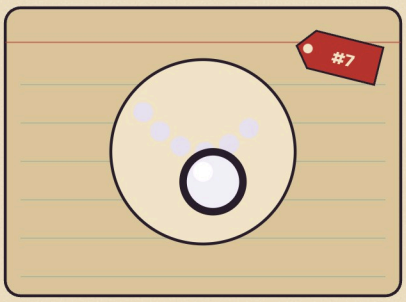
Fresh rose petals

Points to: Gardening

Petals from the manor's prize rose garden.

Two suspects share this

CLUE ④ Blackwood



Loose pearl

Points to: Jewelry

A real pearl from a broken necklace.

Two suspects share this

CLUE ④ Blackwood



Torn leather glove

Points to: Leather gloves

A fine leather glove, torn on a nail.

Two suspects share this

CASE 5 · SOCIETY



The
Mask Keeper

Someone at the Historical Society has been lending out the town's folklore masks, and tonight the oldest of them all, the Hollow Creek Mask, is missing from its case.

Case code HC-05-KEEPER

SUSPECT ⑤ Society



Walter Finch

Night watchman

Brass keys · Old paper dust · Lantern oil

Alibi: Archive

SUSPECT

Society



Edie Wren

Curator

Ink stains · Old paper dust · Fountain pen

Alibi: Reading Room

SUSPECT

Society



Mortimer Vane

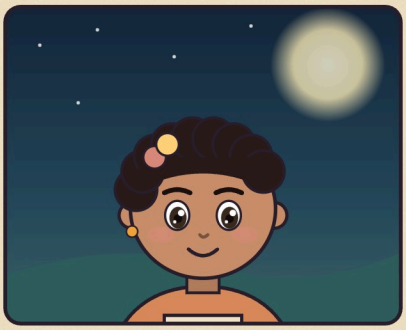
Society treasurer

Ledger pages · Fountain pen · Raffle tickets

Alibi: Diner

SUSPECT

Society



Rosa Delgado

Tea room volunteer

Cake crumbs · Raffle tickets · Lantern oil

Alibi: Gift Shop

CLUE

Society



Ring of brass keys

Points to: Brass keys

The watchman's keys, every door in the building, dropped in a hurry.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE

Society



Inky fingerprint

Points to: Ink stains

A fresh, inky fingerprint on the glass of the mask case.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE

Society



Torn ledger page

Points to: Ledger pages

A page from the society's accounts, columns of sums circled in red.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE

Society



Cake crumbs

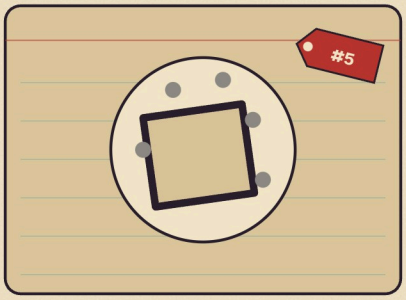
Points to: Cake crumbs

Crumbs of lemon drizzle cake, all the way along the gallery rope.

Only one suspect has this

CLUE

Society



Old paper dust

Points to: Old paper dust

Grey dust from very old paper, the kind that lives in the archive and the reading room.

Two suspects share this

CLUE

Society



Lantern oil

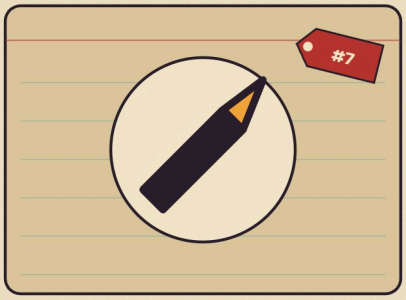
Points to: Lantern oil

A drip of lantern oil, from the kind of lamp you carry on rounds or into a cold storeroom.

Two suspects share this

CLUE

Society 5



Fountain pen nib

Points to: Fountain pen

A gold fountain pen nib, snapped off. Only a few people here still write with one.

Two suspects share this

CLUE

Society 5



Raffle tickets

Points to: Raffle tickets

A strip of raffle tickets from the Halloween fundraiser, numbers 101 to 110.

Two suspects share this

MYSTERY CLUB



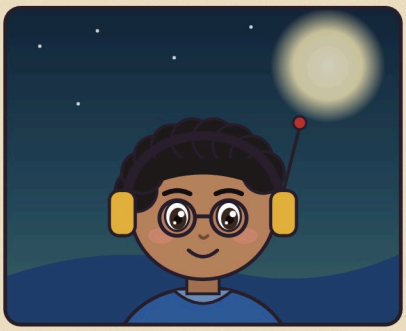
The Sleuth

Read the Room

Once a round, look at one face-down clue token in your space.

Fear ○ ○ ○ ● ●

MYSTERY CLUB



The Techie

Ghost Meter

Before the Haunter moves, ask: is it within 3 spaces of me?

Fear ○ ○ ○ ● ●

MYSTERY CLUB



The Brawn

Steady Hands

Carry 2 trap pieces. Fear from Possess cards can't reach you.

Fear ○ ○ ○ ● ●

MYSTERY CLUB



The Snacker

Snack Break

Spend a Snack token: everyone in your space drops 1 Fear.

Fear ○ ○ ○ ● ●

FOLKLORE MASK



The Headless Horseman

Pumpkin Toss

Burst a pumpkin on a space next to the Haunter: every Solver there gains 1 Fear.

FOLKLORE MASK



The Banshee

Wail

Every Solver within 2 spaces gains 1 Fear, then moves 1 space away.

FOLKLORE MASK



Stingy Jack

Lantern Trick

Swap one lit lantern on the board with an empty space. It still counts, if they can find it.

FOLKLORE MASK



Baba Yaga

Hex

Put a Hex token on a path. Crossing it costs a Solver 1 extra move.

HAUNT



Possess!

Possess

A chair, a lamp or a teapot jumps. Solvers in the case house gain 1 Fear and drop a clue token where they stand.

HAUNT



Fog Rolls In

Fog

Lay a fog cloud on any 3 spaces. Solvers there can't Search this round.

HAUNT



Lights Out

Flicker

Turn one lit lantern face down. Relight it with an action.

HAUNT



Phantom Double

Illusion

Put a second Haunter standee 4 spaces away. Only the Ghost Meter or a Search shows which is real.

HAUNT



Slam!

Door

Block one path next to the Haunter until the end of the next round.

HAUNT



Midnight Chime

Clock

The town clock skips ahead. Move the midnight marker one extra hour, unless 6 or more lanterns are lit.

HAUNTED PLACE



Ravencrag Castle

The suit of armour walks the battlements.

Bust it: the Brawn and a lit lantern on the castle space.

Reward: 1 Curio token

HAUNTED PLACE



Cackling Circus

A ventriloquist's dummy laughs in the empty tent.

Bust it: the Snacker plus any Solver, and one Snack token.

Reward: 1 Curio token

HAUNTED PLACE



Crowley Tower

The lift runs all night with nobody in it.

Bust it: the Techie on the tower space for a whole round.

Reward: 1 Curio token

HAUNTED PLACE



Saltmarsh Harbor

The lighthouse lamp flickers out at midnight.

Bust it: carry 2 lantern tokens to the harbor space.

Reward: 1 Curio token

HAUNTED PLACE



Smugglers' Cave

Ghost lights bob deep inside the cave.

Bust it: the Sleuth, after finding any 2 clues this game.

Reward: 1 Curio token

HAUNTED PLACE



Witchwood Swamp

A broom sweeps the shack porch by itself.

Bust it: any 2 Solvers on the swamp space together.

Reward: 1 Curio token

UNMASKED

CASE

UNMASKED

SUSPECT

UNMASKED

CLUE

UNMASKED

HAUNT



UNMASKED

FOLKLORE MASK

UNMASKED

HAUNTED PLACE

UNMASKED

CASE

UNMASKED

SUSPECT

UNMASKED

CLUE

UNMASKED · Tokens (cut out; glue to card for thickness)



Decoy markers (hide one under each decoy clue) · Blanks · Lanterns · Curios · Snacks · Hex

